



# The New Muslim Starter Guide

*A warm, honest place to begin — no  
pressure to have it all figured out today.*

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**BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE**

## **You belong here now.**

Whatever brought you to this moment — a long search, a quiet certainty, a single conversation that changed everything — it's enough. You don't need to have memorized anything, prayed perfectly, or understood every ruling to belong.

This guide won't try to teach you everything at once. It's meant to be read slowly, a page at a time, for exactly as long as you need.

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## CHAPTER ONE

# You Belong Here Now

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Not once you know more. Not once you've read the whole Quran. Now.

# 1

## **Sincerity is the starting point — not expertise.**

The Prophet (peace be upon him) taught that actions are judged by intentions. Your intention to submit to Allah sincerely is what makes you Muslim — not fluency in Arabic, not memorized surahs, not years of practice.

"Actions are judged by intentions, and every person will get what they intended."

**Sahih al-Bukhari 1**

## Everything before this moment is wiped clean.

This isn't a small comfort — it's a stated promise. Whatever came before your shahada doesn't follow you into it.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) told 'Amr ibn al-'As: "Islam wipes out whatever came before it."

**Sahih Muslim 121**

### 3

## Religion was made easy — not effortless, but easy.

If something feels heavy right now, that's not a sign you're doing it wrong. It's a sign you're early. The Prophet (peace be upon him) himself warned against making faith harder than it needs to be.

"The religion is ease... so take a middle course, if you can't be perfect, then come close."

**Sahih al-Bukhari 39**

## CHAPTER TWO

# The Five Pillars, Simply

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The whole structure of practice, without the overwhelm.



## Five simple commitments, built up over a lifetime.

### 1 Shahada

Declaring there is no god but Allah, and Muhammad (peace be upon him) is His messenger. You've likely already said this.

### 2 Salah

Five daily prayers. You'll build up to this – see Chapter 3 for where to start.

### 3 Zakat

A small yearly share of savings given to those in need – only once you have savings above a set threshold.

### 4 Sawm

Fasting during Ramadan, one month a year – dawn to sunset, no food or drink.

### 5 Hajj

Pilgrimage to Makkah, once in a lifetime, only if you're physically and financially able.

## **You don't build all five at once.**

Most of these take time, stability, or specific conditions (savings, health, season of the year). Right now, your focus is simply the first two: the declaration you've made, and slowly building toward prayer.

### CHAPTER THREE

# Learning to Pray

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One small step at a time — not all five prayers on day one.

# 1

## **You don't need perfect Arabic to start.**

Salah does have fixed Arabic recitations (Surah Al-Fatiha, the takbir), but learning them is a gradual process. Many people start by reciting phonetically from transliteration while they memorize — this is completely normal and doesn't make your prayer less valid.

## **Start with one prayer, not all five.**

Trying to build all five prayers into your day overnight is where most people burn out. Pick one — many start with Maghrib (right after sunset, easy to remember) or Isha (at night, less time pressure) — and build consistency there first.

## The basic shape of salah.

Face the Qibla, make the intention, say the opening takbir ("Allahu Akbar"), recite Al-Fatiha, bow, prostrate, sit — repeated in a set number of cycles (rak'ahs) depending on the prayer. It looks like a lot written out; it becomes automatic within weeks of practice.

## **A missed prayer isn't a failed week.**

You will miss prayers while you're building this habit — everyone does, including lifelong Muslims. What matters is returning to it, not maintaining an unbroken streak from day one.

## CHAPTER FOUR

# Common Myths & Questions

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What new Muslims worry about most — and the truth.



## MYTH

### "I have to change my name."

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**Truth:** you don't, unless your current name has a meaning that directly contradicts Islamic belief (very rare). Many Muslims keep their given names permanently. A new name is a personal choice, never a requirement.

## MYTH

### "I need to know Arabic before I do anything."

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**Truth:** Arabic is learned gradually, alongside practice, not as a prerequisite to it. Personal dua can be made in your own language from day one — see SabrTime's guide on [making dua in English](#) if this worry feels familiar.

## MYTH

# "One mistake and it's like I never accepted Islam."

**Truth:** mistakes don't erase your faith. Islam has a built-in, well-established path back after any misstep — repentance, not disqualification.

"Every son of Adam sins, and the best of those who sin are those who repent."

**Jami' at-Tirmidhi 2499**

#### COMMON QUESTION

### **"Can I still be close to non-Muslim family?"**

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Yes. Maintaining kindness and connection with family, regardless of their faith, is directly encouraged in Islam. Accepting Islam isn't meant to isolate you from the people who love you.

## CHAPTER FIVE

# Small Daily Habits

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The quiet, small things that build faith over time.

# 1

## **Dhikr can be three words, said often.**

"SubhanAllah" (Glory be to Allah), "Alhamdulillah" (Praise be to Allah), "Allahu Akbar" (Allah is Greatest) — three short phrases you can say anytime: waiting in line, commuting, before sleep. This is real, valid worship, not a lesser version of it.

## **Talk to Allah in your own words.**

Dua doesn't require memorized Arabic. You can speak to Allah directly, in whatever language you think in, about exactly what's on your mind. That's not a lesser form of dua — it's the most natural one.

## One dua to keep close, from the start.

رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي

*Rabbi-shrah li sadri wa yassir li amri*

My Lord, expand for me my chest, and ease my task for me.

**Surah Ta-Ha 20:25-26**



## **Consistency beats intensity, every time.**

A tiny habit repeated daily builds more than an ambitious routine attempted twice and abandoned. Pick one small thing — one dhikr, one dua, one prayer — and let it be genuinely small enough to actually keep doing.

## CHAPTER SIX

# You Are Not Alone

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Finding your place in something much larger than one person's practice.

# 1

## **Every lifelong Muslim was once exactly where you are.**

There was a first prayer, a first fumbled recitation, a first uncertain moment for every single person who now prays with ease. What looks effortless in others took the same beginning you're in now.

## **The masjid is a good next step, whenever you're ready.**

A local masjid isn't just for prayer — it's often where practical questions get answered face-to-face, and where community naturally starts. There's no deadline for when to go for the first time.

## A FINAL WORD

# This is a beginning, not a test.

There's no finish line where you're suddenly "Muslim enough." Every prayer, every dhikr, every small effort — from today onward — is the practice itself, not preparation for some later, more complete version of you.

May Allah make this easy for you, and make you steady in it.

CONTINUE FROM HERE

## SabrTime can help you build the habit.

### Free, no ads, no login

Prayer times, Qibla compass, a dua library, and a tasbeeh counter to help you build consistency from day one.

**[sabertime.in](https://sabertime.in)**

More guides at [sabertime.in/blog](https://sabertime.in/blog) and [sabertime.in/e-books](https://sabertime.in/e-books).

Sources: Sahih al-Bukhari 1, 39 · Sahih Muslim 121 · Jami' at-Tirmidhi 2499 · Surah Ta-Ha 20:25-26.